

The Ultimate Reminder

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[A NOTE FOR YOU, THE PREACHER]

- Night 4: The Ultimate Reminder
- This is one of the key messages in the series. The Sabbath is one of the distinctive truths that God has given to His people in these last days. This message builds on the previous topic (the law of God). Now that the importance of the law has been established, it is easier to present the importance of the Sabbath.
- This message addresses the Sabbath from the standpoint of remembering God as our Creator, as emphasized in His last-day message found in Revelation 14.
- It begins with a review of the importance of the law of God (this time, connected to Revelation 14), then introduces the Sabbath as the reminder of our Creator. The message then traces the history of the Sabbath, beginning from Creation and continuing all the way to the end of time, when it is kept by God's faithful people.
- The appeal is simple: Are you willing to follow Jesus wherever He leads? You will ask individuals to stand. The Sabbath truth is possibly a new concept for your visitors, and it takes time to process and make such an important decision. Yet even at this point it is important to establish and affirm their loyalty to Jesus. If they truly surrender to Jesus, they will choose to follow Him in keeping His Sabbath.
- You may want to share some personal experience of how the Sabbath has impacted and blessed you. Slide 40 (about how God blessed the seventh day) or 61 (about how God has faithful people who keep the Sabbath) would be ideal places to share a personal experience/testimony about the Sabbath.
- Pray earnestly and preach compassionately, yet courageously!

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- The title of the message tonight is, "The Ultimate Reminder."

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- Tomorrow, the topic will be "How to Start Life Over Again."
- Have you ever wished that you could go back in time and start all over again?

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- How great would it be if we could take our faults and bury them in a big hole!
- How nice it would be if we could bury the past so that it does not disturb us again!

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- In his last words to his disciples, Jesus shared the key to burying the past and starting a new life.
- A person's last words are important, but the last words of Jesus are even more important.
- Tomorrow night we will examine the last words of Christ.

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- Tomorrow, we will discover How to Start Life Over Again.
- Come tomorrow and bring a friend with you.

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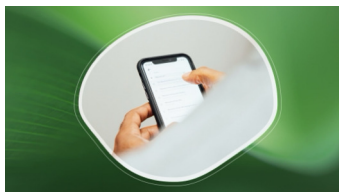
- Now, let us begin the message for tonight is: "The Ultimate Reminder."
- Join me as we pray to ask for the guidance and blessing of God.

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- We live in an age of technology. We have many different devices that perform different functions for us. One of the most important devices we use is our phones.

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- On many phones, there is an application that gives us reminders.
- [Share about how you use your phone to remind you about different things.]

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- Tonight, we are going to look at a reminder that God has given us. Often, from day to day, in the business of work or school or family, we forget to put God first. And so, in His love He gives us reminders.

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- In Revelation 14, we read about an important reminder that God gives to the world to prepare us for the return of Jesus. The same Jesus who died on the cross, rose from the grave, and ascended to heaven, is coming back soon.
- God wants us to be ready for the return of Jesus. So, He gives us a reminder of the most important things in life. He reminds us to put Him first.
- In Revelation 14:6-7, we read this reminder.

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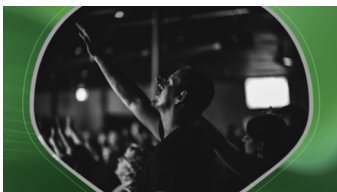
- Revelation 14:6 (NKJV): Then I saw another angel flying in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach to those who dwell on the earth—to every nation, tribe, tongue, and people—

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- Revelation 14:7 (NKJV): saying with a loud voice, “Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and worship Him who made heaven and earth, the sea and springs of water.”

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- Many people today claim to worship Jesus, but they do not give Him glory. They may go to church each week; they may be involved in religious activities; they may even be leaders, but they do not make their decisions to glorify God. Many people even ignore the instructions God has given in His Word while they claim to love and follow Jesus.

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- Last night, we looked at the importance of the law of God. The ten commandments give us the principles for a life with Jesus. They teach us what it means to walk with Jesus.
- The ten commandments are an expression of the character of God. They reveal to us the foundation of His kingdom—the principle of love.

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- Last night, we learned that “sin is the transgression of the law” (1 John 3:4). We have all sinned. We have all broken the law of God.

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- But Jesus died to pay the penalty of the broken law. He died the death that we deserve. Because of Jesus, we are free from the penalty of the law. But we are not free to continue breaking the law.

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- We come to Jesus in our guilt and weakness. He forgives us, and He also gives us His power. In the strength of Jesus, we can live in harmony with His law. The law shows us our sin; it shows us that we need Jesus. And when we go to Jesus, when we put our trust in Him, He writes His law in our hearts and gives us power to keep the law.

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- There are many Christians today who say that the law of God is no longer valid. They say that the Ten Commandments “have been abolished” - the commandments that God wrote with His own finger. They say that these laws no longer apply to us!
- My friends, this is the lie of Satan. Let us read together in 1 John 3:4-8.

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- 1 John 3:4 (NKJV): Whoever commits sin also commits lawlessness, and sin is lawlessness.
- 1 John 3:8 (NKJV): He who sins is of the devil, for the devil has sinned from the beginning.

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- According to these verses, who is against the commandments of God? Satan.
- If we walk with Jesus, we will keep His commandments.
- Notice what the Bible says in 1 John 2:3-4.

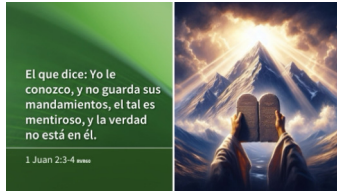
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- 1 John 2:3 (NKJV): Now by this we know that we know Him, if we keep His commandments.

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- 1 John 2:4 (NKJV): He who says, "I know Him," and does not keep His commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him.

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- In the last days of earth's history, Satan is trying to turn people away from God. He does not want us to keep God's commandments. As we look around in our world today, we can see crime and violence; we can see broken homes and conflict in families; these are results of breaking the law of God.

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- But God will have a people who trust in Jesus. They depend on Jesus for forgiveness and salvation, and they choose to follow His plans for them. The Bible describes them in Revelation 14:12.

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- Revelation 14:12 (NKJV): Here is the patience of the saints; here are those who keep the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus.
- That is why God gives a final reminder before the return of Jesus, reminding us to trust in Him, reminding us to keep His commandments. Let us read this reminder again in Revelation 14:7.

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- Revelation 14:7 (NKJV): Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and worship Him who made heaven and earth, the sea and springs of water.
- Let us read another text that is very similar. It will help us to understand what it means to glorify God.

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- Ecclesiastes 12:13 (NKJV): Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter:
- Fear God and keep His commandments,
- For this is man's all.
- We fear God and glorify Him when we keep His commandments.

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- But God's final reminder also tells us to worship Him because He is the Creator. It is very interesting that in the 10 commandments, there is a reminder that God is the Creator.

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- The majority of Christians have no problem with 9 of the 10 commandments. However, they forget the only commandment that starts by saying, "Remember!" "Do not forget!"

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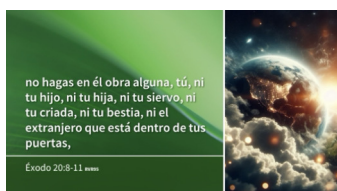
- We set reminders on our phones or write them on paper because we tend to forget things.
- The seventh-day Sabbath is like a reminder on your phone that says, "Do not forget the Creator." So from the beginning, Satan has tried to make humans forget the weekly reminder of God's creative power. Let's take some time to look at this "forgotten commandment." It is such an important reminder that it is the longest of the ten commandments: Exodus 20:8-11.

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- Exodus 20:8–11 (NKJV): Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy. 9 Six days you shall labor and do all your work, 10 but the seventh day is the Sabbath of the Lord your God.

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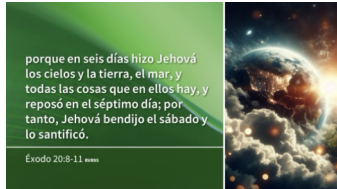


- Exodus 20:8-11(NKJV): In it you shall do no work: you, nor your son, nor your daughter, nor your male servant, nor your female servant, nor your cattle, nor your stranger who is within your gates.

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- Exodus 20:11 (NKJV): For in six days the Lord made the heavens and the earth, the sea, and all that is in them, and rested the seventh day. Therefore the Lord blessed the Sabbath day and hallowed it.

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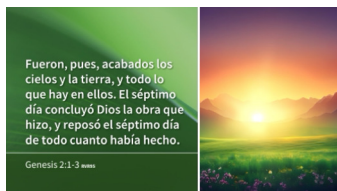
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- There is a strong connection between the commandment on the Sabbath and the biblical teaching of Creation. The Sabbath commandment mentions that the Lord created the heavens and the earth in six days.
- God created light,
- the sky, the air, and the atmosphere.
- He separated the water from the dry land and created plants;
- He created the stars, the sun, and the moon;
- then the sea creatures, the birds,
- and, finally, the land creatures.
- God created a beautiful garden for Adam and Eve, and He gave them the privilege of living in it. It was a perfect environment, and Adam and Eve had perfect joy.
- But God did something special on the seventh day of the week. Let us read together in Genesis 2:1-3.

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- Thus the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the host of them. And on the seventh day God finished his work that he had done, and he rested on the seventh day from all his work that he had done.
- — Genesis 2:1-2

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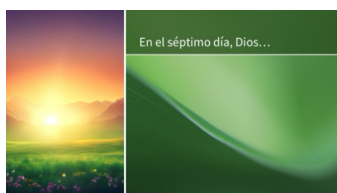
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- So God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it God rested from all his work that he had done in creation.
- — Genesis 2:3

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- Notice that God did three things on the seventh day—things that He did not do on any other day of the week.

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- 1. He rested on that day. He did not work. He did not create anything else. He took time to enjoy the results of His work. He spent the day with Adam and Eve. If it was important to God to stop working for a day, it is important for us as well. We are not more wise or more powerful than God. He rested, and we should rest, too.

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- 2. He blessed the seventh day. He declared it to be good and important. If it is important to God, it should be important to us, too. There is a blessing on the seventh day that we cannot find on any other day.

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- 3. He sanctified the seventh day. The word “sanctify” means “to set apart for a special purpose.”
- Let me illustrate the word “sanctify” in this way. Every day, I take a few water bottles to drink from. There are many water bottles in the package, but I take one or two and set them apart. This is the idea of the word “sanctify.” God took one day and set it apart. The seventh day is unique and special.

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- Here’s another illustration: Suppose that is the day of a wedding. The groom is on the altar along with the bridesmaids. The bride comes down the aisle. The groom’s heart beats faster, his hands are shaking. The preacher says they’re married. After the reception, the car is ready for their honeymoon. One of the six sisters of the bride gets inside the vehicle that will carry the newlyweds to a hotel. She says, “Let’s go!” The bridegroom asks, “What are you doing?? I did not marry you! I married your sister!” She replies, “I am one of the seven. It does not matter! There is no difference!” Of course, it does matter to the bride and groom!

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- Many people ask, “What difference does a day make? Can’t we worship God on any day that we want?” But the Bible is clear that God set apart one specific day in the week. It was the seventh day.
- The seventh-day Sabbath is a reminder that God created the world. It was on the seventh day that God rested from His work of creation, and He calls us to rest on the seventh day each week, as a reminder that He is our Creator.

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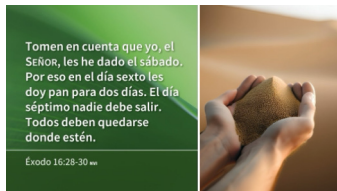
- When God delivered the nation of Israel from slavery in Egypt, He reminded them of the importance of the Sabbath. As they traveled in the wilderness, He gave them manna each day of the week—except the seventh day.
- On the sixth day, which we know as Friday, God gave them twice the amount of manna that they needed, so that they had enough to save for the seventh day. If they tried to save the manna on any other day in the week, the manna was spoiled. But when they saved the manna on the sixth day of the week, it remained good for the Sabbath.
- There were some people who did not follow God's instructions.
- Notice what God said to them in Exodus 16:28-30.

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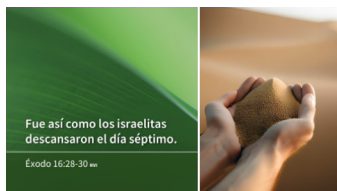
- Exodus 16:28-30 (NIV): How long will you refuse to keep my commands and my instructions?

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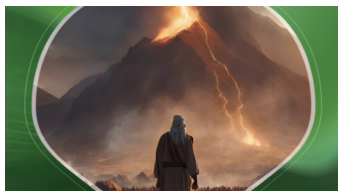
- Exodus 16:28-30 (NIV): Bear in mind that the Lord has given you the Sabbath; that is why on the sixth day he gives you bread for two days. Everyone is to stay where they are on the seventh day; no one is to go out.

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- Exodus 16:28-30 (NIV): So the people rested on the seventh day.
- Each week, for the 40 years of the Israelites' journey, the miracle of the manna was a reminder of the importance of the Sabbath.

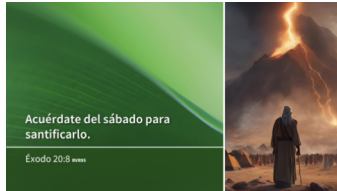
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- When the Israelites traveled to Mount Sinai, God reminded them again about the Sabbath. He spoke His law in power and majesty. There was thunder and lightning. His voice proclaimed the ten commandments, and at the center of the commandments was a reminder about the Sabbath. Let us read it together in Exodus 20:8-11.

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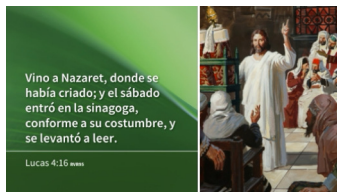
- “Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy.” –Exodus 20:8.
- This is the only commandment that begins with the word “Remember.” God told us to remember because He knew that we would forget. Throughout history, God’s faithful people listened to God’s reminder. They kept the Sabbath and remembered the Creator.

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- When Jesus came to this earth, He obeyed God’s commands, including the commandment about the Sabbath. Let us read what the Bible says in Luke 4:16.

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- Luke 4:16 (NIV): He went to Nazareth, where he had been brought up, and on the Sabbath day he went into the synagogue, as was his custom. He stood up to read.
- Jesus provided an example of perfect obedience to God’s law. He rested every seventh day and kept the holy Sabbath.

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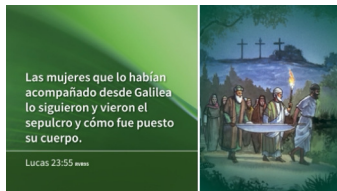
- Even the disciples of Jesus kept the Sabbath. We read about this in the story of Jesus’ death. Jesus died on the sixth day of the week, which we know as Friday.
- Luke 23:54 says:

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- It was the day of Preparation, and the Sabbath was beginning.
- — Luke 23:54
- Now notice what happened next: Luke 23:56.

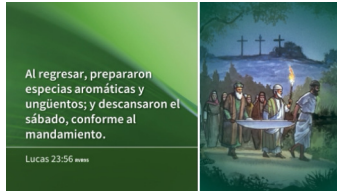
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- The women who had come with him from Galilee followed and saw the tomb and how his body was laid.
- — Luke 23:55
- Now notice the next verse:

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- Then they returned and prepared spices and ointments. On the Sabbath they rested according to the commandment.
- — Luke 23:56
- The disciples of Jesus rested on the Sabbath. In fact, Jesus Himself rested in the grave on the Sabbath.

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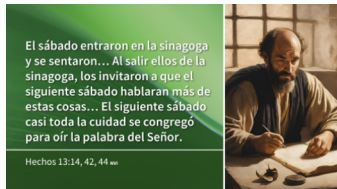
- And according to Luke 24:1, Jesus rose again on the first day of the week. Even at the death of Jesus, the disciples kept the seventh-day Sabbath.

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- In the Book of Acts, we continue to see the disciples keeping the Sabbath. The Bible refers to 84 Sabbaths that were kept by the early Christians.
- Let's look at one example:

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- And on the Sabbath day they went into the synagogue and sat down.
- As they went out, the people begged that these things might be told them the next Sabbath.
- The next Sabbath almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord.
- — Acts 13:14, 42, 44.
- Since the disciples kept the seventh day of the week, the Gentiles said, "We also want to hear this message." This was not just for Jews; it was for the whole city. It is obvious from texts like this that early Christians kept the Sabbath.

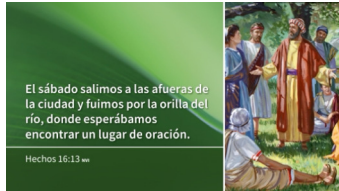
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- In some places there was no place of worship, but believers met together on Sabbath anyway, even outdoors. Acts 16:13 says:

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- And on the Sabbath day we went outside the gate to the riverside, where we supposed there was a place of prayer.— Acts 16:13

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- The Christian church kept the Sabbath during the first 300 years of its existence. And though many Christians today have forgotten about this important commandment, there are Christians today who choose to keep the seventh day of the week, the day that God has blessed and sanctified.

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- I believe that we are living in the last days of earth's history. I believe that Jesus is coming soon. God has an important reminder for each of us. At the beginning of the message, we read about this reminder in Revelation 14:7.

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- Revelation 14:7 (NKJV): Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and worship Him who made heaven and earth, the sea and springs of water.

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- Today, God is looking for people who will recognize Him as the Creator. In a world where so many people have forgotten God, when so many people believe that we came into existence by evolution, when so many people have lost their sense of meaning in life, God calls us to remember Him.
- Those who choose to remember the Creator and worship Him are described in verse 12.

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- Revelation 14:12 (NKJV): Here is the patience of the saints; here are those who keep the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus.

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- Brothers and sisters, I want to be one of those people. I want to depend fully upon Jesus to save me and give me a new life. I want to walk with Jesus and keep His commandments. I want to remember that He is my Creator.

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- Perhaps you have learned some new things tonight. Perhaps you have some important choices to make. But tonight, I want to ask you a simple question. Do you love Jesus? Do you want to follow Him? That's all. If so, please stand up as a symbol of faith so we can pray. If we choose to walk with Jesus, He will lead us to His truth. He will reveal His purpose for us. Our part is to say "Yes" to Jesus and follow Him wherever He goes.
- Let us pray together.